# The Rubrica Field Guide

This booklet is a fictional reference document generated purely as a test fixture. It exists to give the viewer, the search index, and the text-selection layer something realistic to chew on: ordinary paragraphs, section headings, and enough pages that scrolling and pagination behave the way they would for a document a person actually opens.

## 1. Opening a document

When a file is opened, the application reads just enough of it to describe its shape: how many pages it has, how large each page is, and whether it carries a form or requires a password. The rest of the content loads lazily, tile by tile, so a document with hundreds of pages feels no heavier to open than one with three.

Recently opened files are remembered locally, together with the page and zoom level you left off at, so returning to a long report the next morning drops you back exactly where you stopped reading the night before, without any extra clicking.

## 2. Reading and searching

Selecting text should feel the same as selecting text anywhere else: click and drag across a sentence, double-click a word, triple-click a paragraph. Under the hood this relies on a per-page text layer that maps every visible character back to a precise rectangle, which is also what powers copy-and-paste and the search highlighter.

Search results stream in as they are found rather than waiting for the whole document to be scanned first. On a short document this difference is invisible; on a long one it means the first match appears almost immediately instead of after several seconds of silence.

## 3. Annotating a page

Highlights, underlines, and strikeouts attach to the text they cover using quadrilateral points, the same mechanism every standard PDF reader understands. A sticky note is simpler still: a single anchor point and a block of text that only appears when the reader opens it.

Freehand ink strokes and shapes are stored as a sequence of points rather than a picture, which keeps the file small and the marks crisp at any zoom level. None of these tools modify the words underneath the mark; they sit on top, exactly like a real pen on real paper.

## 4. Editing the page order

A document is rarely finished in the order it was scanned or exported. Pages can be dragged into a new order, rotated a quarter turn at a time, deleted outright, or inserted blank or from another file entirely. Every one of these operations can be undone, one step at a time, for as long as the document stays open.

## 5. Filling in a form

Government forms, applications, and questionnaires typically arrive as a page of labelled boxes: a name field here, a checkbox there, a small group of mutually exclusive radio buttons further down, sometimes a dropdown list of districts or categories. Filling one in should feel like filling in a web form, not like drawing text boxes by hand.

## 6. A closing note on portability

Every change this application makes is expressed using constructs that any standards-compliant PDF reader already understands: standard annotation types, standard form fields, standard page content streams. A file saved here should look identical whether it is reopened in this application, in a browser, or on a phone six months later.

That portability guarantee is the actual acceptance test behind every feature described above: an edit that only looks right in one particular viewer is treated as a defect, not a curiosity, regardless of how convenient it was to implement.

## 7. Whiteout versus redaction

These two tools look similar at a glance and are treated very differently underneath. Whiteout paints an opaque shape over a region of the page; the words underneath still exist in the file, they are simply covered up, the same way a piece of correction tape covers ink on real paper without removing it.

True redaction goes further: it removes the underlying text and image objects entirely and replaces the region with a flat rasterized block, so there is nothing left to recover by selecting, copying, or opening the file in a different tool. Choosing the wrong one of these two tools has real consequences, which is why the interface never lets the distinction blur.

## 8. Editing text in place

Occasionally a single typo or an outdated figure needs correcting without retyping an

entire page. Editing a run of text in place reuses the original embedded font whenever it is available and usable, and falls back to a substitute font only when it has no other choice, flagging that substitution visibly rather than silently changing the look of the page.

This kind of in-place editing deliberately does not reflow surrounding paragraphs the way a word processor would. A PDF page is a fixed layout, not a flowing one, and preserving that fixed layout is treated as a feature rather than a limitation to work around.

## 9. Printing and multiple documents

Printing renders the requested pages at a chosen resolution ahead of time, so the print dialog shows exactly what will land on paper rather than a live, possibly slower, preview. Several documents can stay open at once in separate tabs, each with its own undo history, its own zoom level, and its own save state, entirely independent of the others.

## 10. Working without a network connection

None of the behaviour described in this guide depends on a network connection. Opening a file, editing it, filling in a form, saving it back to disk — every one of these operations happens entirely on the machine in front of you. The only feature that ever reaches out to the network is the optional update check, and even that can be switched off entirely.

## 11. A note on recents and preferences

The list of recently opened documents, along with the page and zoom level each one was left at, is kept in a small local database rather than inside the documents themselves. Clearing that list, or turning off the feature entirely, never touches the underlying files: it only forgets where you were, not what you did.

Preferences follow the same rule. A setting such as a default zoom level or a preferred theme is stored once, locally, and applied the next time the application starts, without ever being written into a document or transmitted anywhere.